

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 802

By Mitchell

A RESOLUTION to honor Tennessean Ty Simpson of Martin on his outstanding career in college football.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing a young man who, having already achieved great success in high school and college football, will most certainly continue to shine on the NFL gridiron and excel in all aspects of life during a bright future; and

WHEREAS, Ty Simpson established his quarterback credentials at Martin Westview High School, where he threw for 1,888 yards on only 203 attempts with 20 touchdowns as a junior, while rushing for 311 yards and 7 touchdowns; and

WHEREAS, as a senior, Ty led Martin Westview to the promised land by winning the TSSAA Class 2A football title under the direction of Coach Jarod Neal and was named the Tennessee Gatorade Player of the Year after passing for 2,827 yards and 41 touchdowns while rushing for 862 yards and 11 touchdowns on 92 carries during the 2021 championship season; and

WHEREAS, after finishing his high school football career, Ty Simpson was named one of the top quarterback prospects by every national rating service and was highly recruited by major college programs; he ultimately chose to accept a scholarship from the University of Alabama instead of Clemson, Ole Miss, or his home state of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, as a college freshman, Ty played in only four games for the Crimson Tide; in 2023 and 2024, he saw action as a backup quarterback, appearing in twelve games total; and

WHEREAS, after working hard to improve his skills for three seasons and patiently awaiting his time in the spotlight, Ty Simpson earned Alabama's starting quarterback job and was selected as one of the Crimson Tide's permanent team captains for the 2025 season; and

WHEREAS, given the chance to spread his wings, Ty soared to great heights as a quarterback while leading Alabama to a 10-3 record and the quarterfinals of the CFP (College Football Playoffs) Championship; and

WHEREAS, Ty Simpson excelled in his starting role during the 2025 campaign, passing for 28 touchdowns (most in the Southeastern Conference (SEC) and tied for seventh nationally), and 3,500 yards (most in the SEC and fifth in the nation) and averaging 250 passing yards per game (fourth in the SEC and 23rd nationally); he also recorded 87 rushes for 76 yards and two touchdowns on the ground; and

WHEREAS, Ty earned accolades on a weekly basis for his performance on the gridiron and was twice selected SEC Offensive Player of the Week in recognition of his impressive play and leadership in Tide victories over Georgia and Missouri; and

WHEREAS, in the Tide's most impressive victory of the season over the Georgia Bulldogs, Ty Simpson accounted for three total touchdowns, completing 24 of 38 passes for 276 yards and two touchdowns and rushing four times for a pair of first downs and a touchdown; and

WHEREAS, against the Missouri Tigers in Columbia, Ty completed 23 of 31 passes for 200 yards and three touchdowns; and

WHEREAS, in Alabama's impressive 10-point road victory over Oklahoma in the first round of the CFP, Ty Simpson completed 18 of 29 passes for 232 yards and two touchdowns; and

WHEREAS, the recipient of numerous laurels for his outstanding performance and inspiring leadership for Alabama during the 2025 season, Ty was named to the All-SEC Second Team by the Associated Press and league coaches and honored as an All-American by several media outlets; and

WHEREAS, Ty Simpson was named a finalist for the Manning Award, a semifinalist for the Maxwell Award and the Walter Camp Player of the Year award, both of which honor the

nation's top collegiate player, and a semifinalist for the Davey O'Brien Award, which recognizes the top quarterback in college football; and

WHEREAS, Ty has been projected as a first-round selection in the 2026 National Football League Draft; if he is selected on Day One, he will be the seventh former Alabama quarterback to attain this high status, joining Harry Gilmer, Bryce Young, Joe Namath, Tua Tagovailoa, Richard Todd, and Mac Jones; and

WHEREAS, Ty Simpson has distinguished himself as one of the most gifted college football quarterbacks in the nation, and he is richly deserving of our approbation as he prepares for his future career in the NFL; and

WHEREAS, on this auspicious occasion, we can positively state that while not all Tennesseans can say "Roll Tide," they can most definitely support "Roll Ty!"; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor Tennessean Ty Simpson of Martin on his many accomplishments in college football as quarterback for the Alabama Crimson Tide and wish him much continued success in his upcoming NFL career.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.